



SPORTS AWARD WINNERS—John Phelan, left, was named the Sportsman of the Year Wednesday by the Temple Mount Sinai Men's Club during the club's seventh annual dinner. Pictured left to right are Phelan; Bob Beamon, co-winner of the Amateur Athlete of the Year award; Olympics hero and speaker Jesse Owens; Andy Cohen, master of cere-

monies; Kerry Pearce, co-winner of the Amateur Athlete of the Year award, and Don Whittington, who accepted the Professional Athlete of the Year award for U.S. Open champ Lee Trevino who is in California to play in the Kaiser Open Golf Tournament.

Phelan Named Sportsman Of Year; Beamon, Pearce, Trevino Honored

By CHUCK WHITLOCK

John Phelan was named Sportsman of the Year, world record holders Bob Beamon and Kerry Pearce and National Open golf champion Lee Trevino shared Athlete of the Year laurels and Jesse Owens, the greatest of them all, captured the hearts of the 400 fathers, sons and guests as principal speaker at the seventh annual Sports Awards banquet of Temple Mt. Sinai Men's Club Monday night.

Phelan, honored as the man who brought baseball back to El Paso when he organized El Paso Sports Association in 1961, and as one of the founders of El Paso Press Club and El Paso Athletic Hall of Fame, received a large trophy and a surprise greeting from his wife, Eloise, and daughter, Judy, as climax of the program.

A longtime sportscaster for KTSM radio and TV, Phelan came to El Paso after World War II and has been intimately connected with sports since that time. He served as general manager and president of El Paso Sun Kings through

1963, and for two years was vice president of the Texas League. He has won a number of civic honors.

Beamon, former University of Texas at El Paso athlete, stunned the world last fall when he shattered the world record in the long jump with an Olympic Games leap of 29-feet-2½ inches, a feat rated as the greatest performance in the history of sports.

Pearce set the world indoor record for the two-mile run last year and in addition holds other American records for distance running. He is a member of the U.T. El Paso track squad. A native of Australia, Pearce said in his acceptance of the award that he plans to become a citizen of the United States.

Trevino swept to victory in the National Open Tournament in June with a record-setting fourth-round rush, and later annexed the Hawaiian Open championship to rank among the top 10 golfers and money winners for the year.

The Horizon Hills Golf and Country Club professional was unable to attend the dinner, since he is playing in the Kaiser Open in Napa, Calif., and his award was received for him by Don Whittington of the Horizon Hills club.

Owens, hero of the 1936 Olympic Games in Berlin, when he won four gold medals with victories in the 100 meter and 200 meter dashes and the long jump and a leg on the winning 400 meter relay team, drew a tremendous standing

ovation on his introduction.

Pointing much of his comments to the fathers and sons in the audience, Owens stressed the element of team play in family life, and outlined the role of the son as player and the parents as quarterback, and the duties and responsibilities of each.

Using anecdotes and descriptions of the Olympic Games to illustrate his points, he delineated the youngsters as the great athletes, the record breaker of tomorrow.

He said the 1968 Olympics in Mexico City was the most

festive, most competitive of all the Olympic Games in history.

Films of the great performances of Beamon, Pearce and Owens, and another of Trevino in action, were interspersed at appropriate moments in the program.

And perhaps the greatest commentary of all came from Andy Cohen, who acted as master of ceremonies: "An occasion in which a Jewish Men's Club has a Negro for a principal speaker and presents awards to Catholics and Protestants is truly democracy in action."

Jesuit Travels To Dallas For Cage Meet

Jesuit High School's basketball team will leave early Thursday to journey to Dallas

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